

maintained in your online account. This integration also allows Gmail e-mails to be searched by GDS.

Interestingly, every time you search at Google online, your offline indexes are also scanned, and results (if found) are displayed. The search bar can be customised by the user to appear either as part of the sidebar, or independently. It can also be hidden till a hotkey is pressed. GDS displays matching results even as the keywords are being typed in.

In conclusion, GDS does come across as a better alternative to the default Windows search function. Its way of smudging of the offline/online distinction can be an irritant, though.

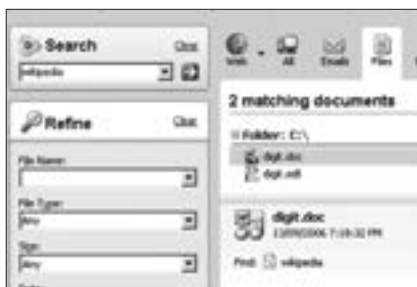
4.3.2 Copernic Desktop Search

(www.copernic.com/en/products/desktop-search/)

Online, Copernic is a meta search engine, which means it employs more than one search engine to arrive at its results. Offline, it is akin to GDS. Unlike GDS, it has its own user interface. CDS, too, has a Crawler that does the indexing, and a front-end that does the reporting.

Other reasons that make it slightly more attractive than GDS include:

- Out of the box, CDS is able to index more file types that GDS—including, the file types used by the popular, free, Openoffice.org Office suite—.ods, odt., etc. Any file content type not already included in the searchable types can be included manually, and the mode of search—filename or file content—can also be set. Compare this with GDS, which



CDS' results and preview window